Nimmi was pregnant again. Our fourth child, a son, was born in December 1970. When I gazed down into his eyes, I saw my reflection in them. We named him Chiranjeev Milkha Singh.

Nimmi was a devoted wife and mother. I am still amazed by how efficiently she managed her personal and professional life without letting either of them suffer. She was the perfect housewife, running our home so smoothly that all our needs were taken care of. She ensured that there was always good, hearty food on the table, looked after the children, supervised their homework, and yet, never neglected her official responsibilities. But, we still worried, that as working parents, could we give the children the stability they required while they were growing up? Reluctantly, we decided to send Aleeza, Mona, and even Sonia who just three years old, to St Mary's Convent, a boarding school in Kasauli, a hill station a short distance away from Chandigarh. Nimmi was so distraught by this separation that every evening she would look up at the lights of Kasauli and cry—she missed her daughters very much. I couldn't bear to see her so upset and after a few months we brought the girls down and enrolled them in Sacred Heart Convent in Chandigarh.

As a family we shared many interests, attending school events, travelling and a passionate love for dogs. My first pet, in 1958, was a dog I named Dolly after an old girlfriend of mine. Since then, our home has always been filled with dogs of almost every breed—Labradors, golden retrievers, poodles and even an apso. The children would take them for long walks, play with them, groom and feed them. They still haven't lost their affection for dogs.

During the summer holidays, I would take the family with me for camps in the mountains. It was a good experience for them to see a different way of life, and also to understand and appreciate my vocation. They would also accompany me when I went on shikar, and we would spend many happy days in the jungle.

In those days there was no taboo against hunting; instead, it was regarded as a manly pastime, governed by strict rules and regulations that controlled the number of animals killed, among other restrictions. It was mandatory for keen shikaris, like me, to acquire permits to hunt in certain specially designated game resorts, like the Meetawalli Block near Haridwar, which was also the regular haunt of rich and famous.